

Orientation for Children Policy

NQF

QA6	6.1.1	Engagement with the service - Families are supported from enrolment to be involved in the service and contribute to service decisions.
	6.2.1	Transitions - Continuity of learning and transitions for each child are supported by sharing relevant information and clarifying responsibilities.

National Regulations

Regs	177	Prescribed enrolment and other documents to be kept by approved provider
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Aim

To provide children and families with an orientation procedure that allows the family to transition to their child being in care, transition to a new room within the service or transition to school.

Related Policies

Enrolment Policy

Family Law and Access Policy

Parental Interaction and Involvement in the Service Policy

Physical Environment (Workplace Safety, Learning and Administration) Policy

Relationships with Children Policy

Staffing Arrangements Policy

Unenrolled Children Policy

Implementation

We believe orientation is an important process where educators are able to get important information about the new child's needs and those of the family. This process helps to make the transition from home to care as smooth as possible with the aim to maintain continuity between home and the service, which helps the child adjust to the new setting.

The Nominated Supervisor will arrange for the new child to attend the service (together with parents/s) to visit and meet the educators, and familiarise with the environment. The children may participate in the activities if they so desire. A number of young children prefer to just watch, rather than do. Positive interactions at this time (between parents, educators and the child) are important

for the children to build positive attitudes to the service environment. Educators are aware that some children respond to new experiences faster than others and will adapt to the situation.

At this time, the daily timetable and program will be discussed, as well as routines and any special requirements for the child that may need to be accommodated. Parent/s will also be encouraged to send any special comfort items (teddy etc) to help the child in the initial settling in period. Parents will also be invited to ring and check on their child at any time if there are any concerns.

Part of this orientation visit is also to explain/collect the required documentation for the child (enrolment form, birth certificate, immunisation record and Medicare number etc). Staff will also explain methods of fee payment and communication (newsletters, pockets, communication box etc), what the child will need, the importance of labelling personal items and also show the parent library where they can access the service's policies and other resources. Our enrolment checklist will ensure that all families receive all the information need for a smooth transition into our service.

Educators will also discuss how best to tailor the child's settling in period – with some parents choosing to gradually build up to a full day so the child is reassured that the parents will return to collect them. Educators will encourage parents to say goodbye when dropping off – and reassured that if the child remains distressed over a period of time, that educators will contact them. Parents are able to stay as long as needed to reassure their child, but sometimes it's easier for the educator to settle the child if the parents come earlier on collection to spend time with their child – rather than do this at drop off time.

Parents will be kept informed about how their child is settling in on collection and are welcome to discuss any aspects with the Nominated Supervisor at a convenient time.

Information on the service's child orientation policy will be available in different languages when required.

Transition

Gloucester Pre-School & Ealy Years Learning Centre has mixed age grouping in many of its classrooms. This minimises the need for children to transit from one room to the next according to age. Children may change rooms at the beginning of a new year or during the year if a specific need arises. When the child becomes of the age to attend school, the pre-school will work with the parents and the school to prepare the child for school entry.

Transition from one room to another

Change is harder for some children than others; however, by making this transition as smooth as possible for children and families, we are helping build the child's success. Separation can evoke children's deep feelings which can trigger restlessness, frustration etc.

Implementation

So as to minimise any distress that the transfer may cause;

- Think about the transition ahead of time. Lay the groundwork for a new teacher to get to know their child by sharing information and insights you have gained.
- Talk to families about how their child handles change and the strategies they use to help their child cope with change
- Plan to have the child and family visit the new group more than once if possible.
- Invite the new teacher to visit the child in their room numerous times

- Talk about change, starting from 2 weeks before the transition
- Don't talk about the transition in terms of concern or sorrow
- Talk about their new teacher everyday in general conversation
- Celebrate the child's last day in the room
- Allow the child to visit their old classroom when needed
- Be sure to say goodbye.

Transition to school

When a child first attends school, there is a great change for that child and for their family. We believe that the child's parents are the most important link in this transition.

- The better the transition between home and school, the better the education: that's the message of recent research.
- The pre-school will always talk about starting school in a positive manner that will reinforce a healthy attitude toward the transition.
- Information on local schools will be made available to parents.
- Toward the end of each year an excursions are arranged to visit the local school so as to familiarise the children with the school environment.
- Parents with children who are of eligible age to commence school in the following year will be given a school readiness report during term 4.
- Information regarding school readiness is issued in during term 4.

Sources

**Education and Care Services National Regulations
National Quality Standard**

Review

The Management, Employees, Families and interested parties will monitor and review the effectiveness of this Policy regularly. Updated information will be incorporated as needed.

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| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Reviewed by: Elizabeth Price
Date: 14/07/2021 | Position: Nominated Supervisor
Signature: |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Accepted by Committee Member:
Date: | Position:
Signature: |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Previously reviewed: 27/9/2018 | Date for next review: 14/07/2023 |